

MATTHEW GOURD

London · Senior Documentation Engineer · Technical Writer

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PROFILE

Documentation engineer and technical writer driving developer adoption in high-growth fintech and SaaS. More than 25 years of writing experience, including seven years in developer documentation and building Viva Wallet's developer portal from scratch. Deep expertise in API and SDK documentation, docs-as-code workflows, and AI-assisted authoring, with a focus on getting developers from first read to working integration as quickly as possible.

CORE SKILLS

Documentation expertise: API/SDK documentation, developer portals, information architecture, analytics

Docs-as-code stack: Markdown, AsciiDoc, MDX, Docusaurus, Hugo, Antora, Mintlify, Scalar

API standards: OpenAPI, Swagger, JSON, YAML

Tooling: Git, GitHub, GitLab, VS Code, Cursor, Copilot

AI-assisted authoring: MCP servers, agentic workflows, prompt design for documentation review

Leadership: Distributed team management, mentoring, style guide adoption

EXPERIENCE

Senior Documentation Engineer · Backbase · Dec 2025 to Present

- Lead technical writer for Grand Central, Backbase's integration platform, producing conceptual overviews, quick-start guides, and implementation guidance that cover its architecture, connectors, and APIs for banking implementation teams, working with product and engineering subject-matter experts.
- Payments specialist for Backbase's implementation documentation (Backbase.io), producing guidance used by internal delivery teams, integration partners, and clients implementing payment capabilities.
- Created AI workflows that accelerate codebase discovery, terminology mapping, and gap analysis, enabling a 164% year-over-year increase in documentation output.
- Built and shipped sync pipelines that automatically keep published documentation aligned with the delivery systems it describes, running across multiple repositories.

Documentation Manager · Backbase · Jul 2023 to Nov 2025

- Led a distributed team of four technical writers, introducing shared review practices and mentoring writers toward more consistent, independent output.
- Wrote developer guides with engineering and solution teams for complex banking software.
- Introduced AI-assisted authoring workflows to the team while maintaining rigorous quality standards and repeatable review practices.

Senior Technical Writer · Backbase · Nov 2021 to Jul 2023

- Created technical and integration documentation for global banking software.
- Implemented the Google Developer Documentation Style Guide across EMEA teams.
- Improved peer review processes and content strategy to enable faster, more reliable release cycles.

Technical Account Manager · Viva Wallet · May 2021 to Oct 2021

- Acted as the primary technical liaison for enterprise clients during high-stakes system incidents.
- Produced payment API guides and technical enablement content to support developer adoption.
- Built a fully automated docs-as-code pipeline using GitHub and Markdown.

Technical Writer · Viva Wallet · Jan 2019 to Apr 2021

- Launched the company's first developer portal, replacing outdated documentation with a modern, searchable docs-as-code platform built from the ground up.
- Produced API, SDK, and plugin documentation for the payments platform, partnering with engineering to cut onboarding time and reduce integration support requests.
- Established documentation analytics and feedback loops to enable data-driven content optimisation.

Digital Content Officer · University of the Arts London · Apr 2018 to Dec 2018

- Involved in a large-scale content migration during a CMS transition affecting more than 20,000 students.
- Redesigned online forms and workflows to better support a diverse student population.

Technical Writer · ipagoo · Sep 2017 to Feb 2018

- Produced Open Banking API documentation during a critical regulatory transition.
- Built and shipped the company's first developer portal in a high-growth fintech startup environment.

Technical Writer (Contract) · MIRACL · Jun 2016 to May 2017

- Authored documentation for complex cryptographic SDKs and multi-factor authentication platforms.
- Conducted technical reviews and platform testing on AWS infrastructure for worldwide deployment.

Technical Writer (Contract) · Mumsnet · Mar 2016 to May 2016

- Created onboarding documentation for distributed Java, iOS, and Android teams.
- Designed infrastructure diagrams and process flows supporting remote engineering operations.

Web Manager · Chartered Institute of Public Relations · Aug 2012 to Mar 2016

- Managed content strategy for the corporate website serving PR professionals across multiple regions.
- Led digital campaigns, including national awards, by coordinating remote cross-departmental teams.

Earlier roles across enterprise software, telecoms, and professional services (including Fujitsu and BT) established the foundations in API and product documentation, content strategy, and editorial process that underpin current senior work.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Using Generative AI in Technical Writing · Cherryleaf, 2025
- Agentic AI for Developers: Concepts and Application for Enterprises · LinkedIn Learning, 2025
- People Manager Program · Lepaya, 2024

EDUCATION

University of Wales, BSc (Hons) Technology Management (part-completed)